

After Tooth Restoration

Simple after-care instructions to help your new restoration settle and last

WHAT IS NORMAL?

Mild sensitivity to cold or pressure can occur for a short time after a filling or other restoration. The tooth and surrounding tissues may also feel slightly different while you get used to the restoration.

REMEMBER

Give the restoration time to settle. If your dentist has advised a crown, onlay or further treatment, do not delay it.

1. For the first few hours

- Wait until the numbness has completely worn off before eating so you do not accidentally bite your cheek, lip or tongue.
- Avoid very hot food or drinks while you are still numb.
- If a temporary restoration has been placed, follow the specific instructions given by your dentist.

2. Eating and chewing

- Start with softer foods if the tooth feels tender.
- Avoid very hard or sticky foods on the restored tooth, particularly if a temporary filling or crown is present.
- Do not bite ice, pens, nails or other hard objects with the restored tooth.
- If possible, chew on the opposite side until the tooth feels comfortable.

3. Sensitivity and discomfort

- Mild sensitivity to cold or pressure can occur after a restoration and should generally settle.
- Use pain-relieving medication only if advised by your dentist/doctor and according to the medication instructions.
- If sensitivity is severe, worsening, or does not improve as expected, contact your dentist.

4. Brushing and flossing

- Continue normal oral hygiene. Brush twice daily and floss regularly.
- Clean around the restored tooth as you normally would unless your dentist has given different instructions.
- Good oral hygiene helps protect both the restoration and the surrounding tooth.

5. If your bite feels high

- Your restored tooth may occasionally feel as though it touches first when you bite.
- **Do not try to adjust the restoration yourself.** Contact your dentist so the bite can be checked and adjusted if needed.

6. Protect your restoration

- Even strong restorations can be damaged by excessive forces. Avoid chewing very hard objects.
- If you grind or clench your teeth, ask your dentist whether a protective night guard may be appropriate.
- Maintain regular dental examinations so the restoration and surrounding tooth can be checked.

7. When should you contact us?

- **Contact your dentist if you develop:**
 - Severe or persistent pain
 - Cold or hot sensitivity that does not settle
 - Pain when biting that persists or worsens

- A restoration that feels loose, sharp or broken
- A filling, crown or other restoration that comes out
- Swelling or signs of infection

Important: These are general patient-education instructions and do not replace personalised advice from your treating dentist. After-care can vary depending on the type of restoration and the tooth treated.

References

1. American Dental Association. Oral Health Topics: Fillings. Patient information.
2. American Dental Association. Oral Health Topics: Crowns. Patient information.
3. European Society of Endodontology. Position statement: The restoration of root filled teeth. Int Endod J. 2021.